



UNIT 2

VALUES AND DISPOSITIONS



A TALE OF VALOUR

MAJOR SOMNATH SHARMA AND THE BATTLE OF BADGAM



0873CH02

Let us do these activities before we read.

I Work in pairs. Share your answers with your classmates and teacher.

1. What do you think about the Republic Day Parade on 26 January?
2. What are the highlights of this parade?
3. What bravery awards are given on this day, and who receives them?

II Work in groups of four and discuss.

1. What qualities do you think a soldier should have?
2. If you had to share a message with a soldier, what would it be?





Let us read

*Mera desh, mera desh re
Mera desh hua re roshan,
le qurban kiya tujh hee pe ye tan man...*

75
Azadi Ka
Amrit Mahotsav



Major Somnath Sharma
(1923–1947)



Kumaon
Regiment Crest

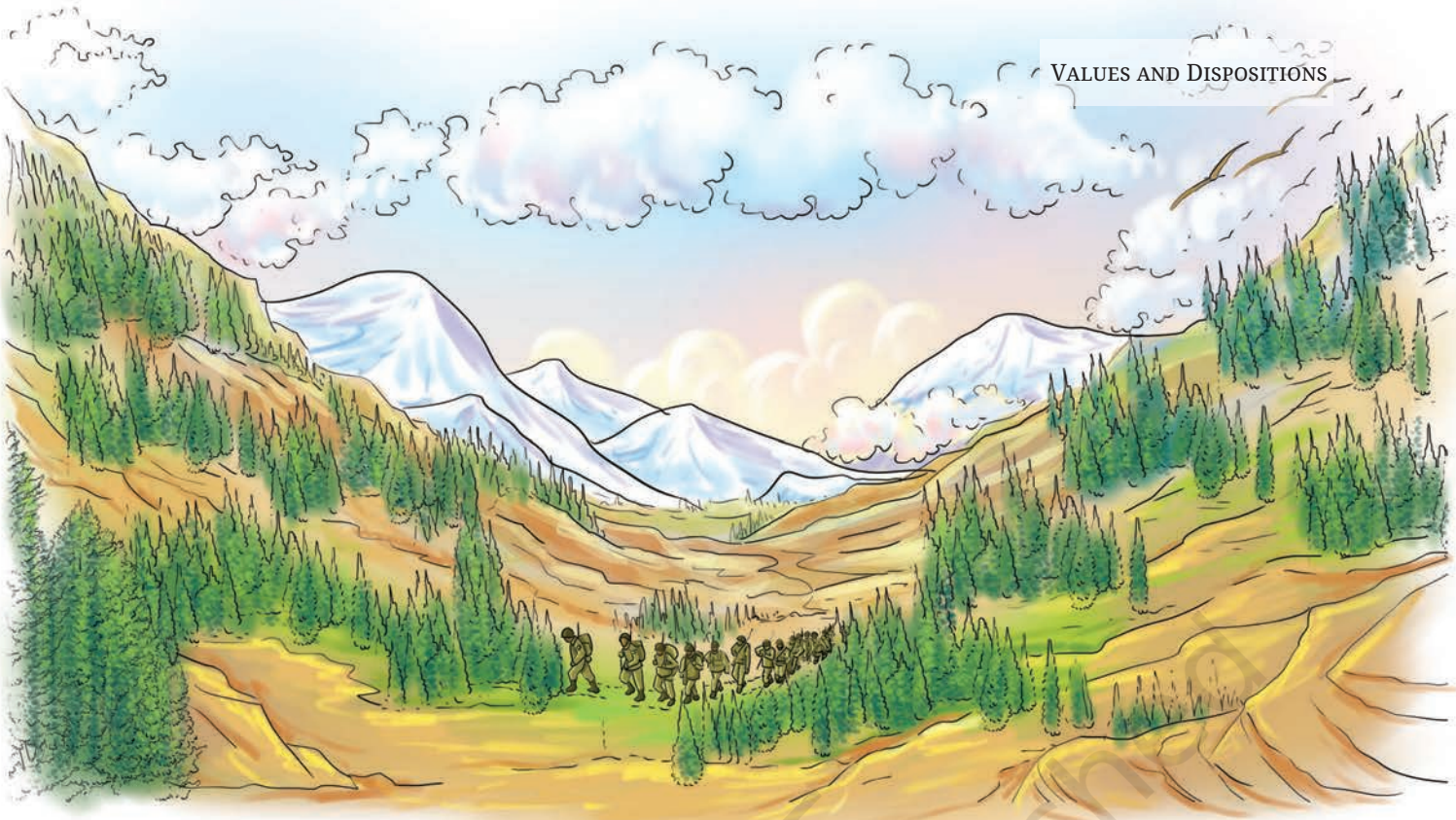
etched:
permanently
fixed in
someone's
memory

beacon: a
source of
inspiration

valour: courage

This is a tribute to the valiant Major Somnath Sharma, India's first recipient of the Param Vir Chakra, whose name is **etched** in the annals of history. His bravery and sacrifice stand as a **beacon** of inspiration for generations. At every intersection of patriotism—whether through the National War Memorial, soul stirring patriotic songs, books, and stories recounting acts of **valour**, or the celebrations of *Azadi ka Amrit Mahotsav*—his memory is honoured. Major Somnath Sharma's legacy of courage and devotion to the nation remains forever alive, forever alive... reminding us of the ultimate price paid for our freedom.

The serene Kashmir valley in the shadows of the majestic Himalayas witnessed a tale of extraordinary heroism and



sacrifice to protect the integrity of Indian borders. The day began with the silence of a cold November dawn but ended with echoes of courage that served as an inspiration for generations to come.

This is the story of Major Somnath Sharma and the brave men that he led on a mission to protect the Srinagar airport from falling into the hands of a guerrilla force trained and backed by Pakistan. This is a story of how 90 men managed to foil the plan of some 500 **infiltrators** who wanted to capture Srinagar and the Kashmir Valley and deliver a blow to newly-independent India.

The events that led to the Battle of Badgam started in August 1947, when Pakistan launched Operation Gulmarg to **annex** the Kashmir Valley. This was in violation of an existing agreement with Hari Singh, the Maharaja of Jammu and Kashmir, who had committed Pakistan not to attack the state.

However, instead of honouring the commitment, the Pakistani Army trained and equipped around 1000 invaders who possessed deep knowledge of mountain passes and the local terrain to enter Kashmir and take control of strategic locations, including the Srinagar airport. The ultimate goal of

infiltrators:
people who
secretly invade

annex: to take
possession of



their plan was to engineer a revolt in Kashmir, overthrow the government, and capture the territory. If they had succeeded, it would have allowed them to control strategic mountain passes, peaks, and rivers. On 22 October, Operation Gulmarg was launched and these infiltrators invaded Kashmir, which led to the Princely State becoming a part of India on 26 October 1947.

In response to this invasion, the Government of India sent its troops to defend the people of Kashmir and India's borders on 27 October 1947. A contingent of troops posted to Jammu and Kashmir was airlifted into Srinagar because the land route through Pathankot was not in a good condition.

On 31 October, the D Company of the 4th Battalion of Kumaon Regiment, under the command of Major Somnath Sharma, was also flown into Srinagar. At that time, Major Somnath Sharma's left hand was in plaster, but he insisted on being with his company while in **combat**. He knew that this mission would be very challenging and told his senior officers, "I know my men better than anyone else, and if they are going into action, they are not going in without me." These words highlighted his commitment to his men and his country.

Before their arrival in Srinagar, there had been **unfounded** rumours of tribal movement towards the village of Badgam, less than 5 kilometres away from the Srinagar airport. The village was on a higher altitude than the airfield, and access was through the village. Hence, it was important for Indian forces to retain control of the area in order to protect troops and facilitate supplies arriving via air.

In reality, the enemy had started arriving in Badgam in small groups to avoid detection. On 03 November 1947, several companies, including Major Somnath Sharma's D Company, were sent to patrol and assess emerging threats in and around the village. Throughout the day, the valley was **eerily** silent. Around afternoon, the companies were ordered to return one by one. D company with 90 soldiers was the last, and they were expected to return by 2:00 p.m.

When the enemy (tribal guerrilla invaders), under the command of the Pakistani army, saw that only a small group

combat: a battle

unfounded: not based on reason or facts

eerily: in a strange, frightening and mysterious way

of Indian soldiers were left behind in Badgam, they attacked them. Their initial attack was met with stiff resistance by Major Somnath and his men. However, Major Somnath correctly visualised that the first attack was just a distraction. Shortly thereafter, a major attack came from another side. By then, Major Somnath Sharma and his 90 soldiers were facing about 500 invaders.

The Pakistani invaders sought to capture the Srinagar airfield and its surrounding areas. It was clear to Major Somnath Sharma that defending Srinagar town, the airfield, and the wider valley was indeed difficult until reinforcements arrived.

After assessing the situation, he requested air strikes. He bravely laid out ground panels to guide the aircraft towards their target. The aerial attacks were successful in hitting the tribal invaders, but they still **outnumbered** D Company by almost seven to one, the attack on the positions occupied by Major Somnath's men continued.

Vastly outnumbered and facing devastating fire, Major Somnath Sharma and his men stood **resolute**. The air was thick with the sound of gunfire and the cries of battle, but Major Somnath Sharma's voice cut through the chaos, urging his men to fight with **tenacity** and valour.

Despite heavy casualties and his own injuries, Major Somnath Sharma displayed **unparalleled** bravery. He moved fearlessly through the battlefield, directing fire, filling **magazines** for his gunners, and encouraging his men to hold their ground.

outnumbered:
were greater in number

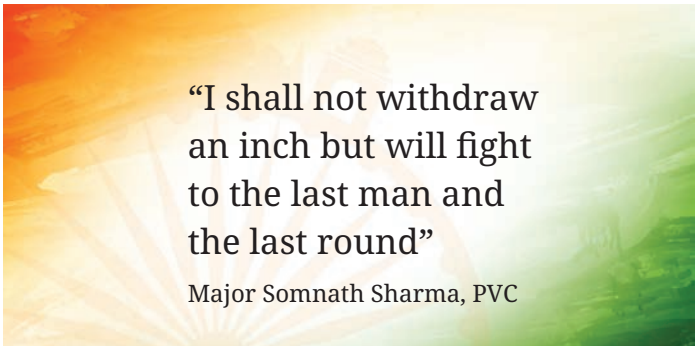
resolute:
determined

tenacity:
determination

unparalleled:
unmatched

magazines:
(here) containers that hold cartridges to be fed into a gun





“I shall not withdraw
an inch but will fight
to the last man and
the last round”

Major Somnath Sharma, PVC



ammunition:
a supply of
bullets, shells,
and explosives

crouched: sat
with knees bent

conspicuous:
noticeable

posthumously:
after death

However, as the battle progressed, D Company began running out of **ammunition**. When Major Somnath Sharma informed Brigade headquarters about this, he was asked to pull back. Aware of the gravity of the situation, he responded with the words, “The enemy is only 50 yards from us. We are heavily outnumbered. We are under devastating fire. I shall not withdraw an inch but will fight to the last man and the last round”.

Just a few minutes later, when he was **crouched** in a trench next to a machine gun operator, in order to help him load the gun, his position was hit by a mortar shell, killing him instantly.

Despite losing their Major and faced with the overwhelming numerical superiority of the enemy, the heroic actions of late Major Somnath Sharma motivated his men to hold on to their position for over six more hours before being overrun by the enemy.

Their brave resistance provided time for reinforcements to arrive, including flying in soldiers from the Punjab regiment to Srinagar. The heroic deeds of Major Somnath and his men thoroughly demotivated the enemy, causing more than 300 casualties, including injuring their leader.

In many significant ways, D Company’s sacrifice and Major Somnath’s leadership saved Srinagar for India. The 4 KUMAON battalion was awarded the Battle Honour, Srinagar. Major Somnath laid down his life for the nation at the young age of 24. For this act of **conspicuous** bravery, Major Somnath Sharma was awarded the Param Vir Chakra (PVC). His citation reflects his heroism, patriotism, and courage. He was the first recipient of the PVC, awarded **posthumously** for gallantry and supreme sacrifice.



MAJ SOMNATH SHARMA, PVC



Subject :- HONOURS AND AWARDS.

Herewith I am forwarding the following names for an immediate award for personal courage and bravery :-

<u>No.</u>	<u>Rank</u>	<u>Name</u>	<u>Unit</u>	<u>Appointment</u>
1.	IC-521 T/	MAJOR SOM NATH SHARMA	4 KUMAON	O.C.'D' COY.

2. **HONOUR RECOMMENDED FOR :-** Immediate Award of M.C.

3. **CITATION :-** On landing at SIRINAGAR Airfield Major S.N.Sharma's 'D' Coy was despatched to BADGAM village, with a view to prevent enemy from infiltrating and attacking SIRINAGAR Airfield. Major Sharma's Coy was involved in action against approximately 1000 enemy strong.



Major Sharma's leadership and personal courage and sacrificing his life by moving from post to post under heavy mortar and automatic fire he was responsible for his Coy holding against an overwhelming majority of enemy for nearly 4 hours and inflicting over 300 casualties on the enemy. Not only this even after his death his personal example of heroic enthusiasm made the Coy to fight for over an hour and only withdrew in an orderly fashion when ordered by the re-inforcement Commander. But for this Offr's bravery and sacrifice of his own life it is most probable that the SIRINAGAR Airfield would have been over run by the enemy and jeopardised the whole KASHMIR operations.

4. **Date and Place of Action :-** 3 Nov'47. BADGAM VILLAGE.

M. N. Khanna
Lt.Col.
Comd 4 Kumaon Regt.
(M.N.KHANNA)



legacy: life experiences, values, beliefs, and traditions passed down from generation to generation

testament: strong evidence or proof

despatches: official reports on military affairs

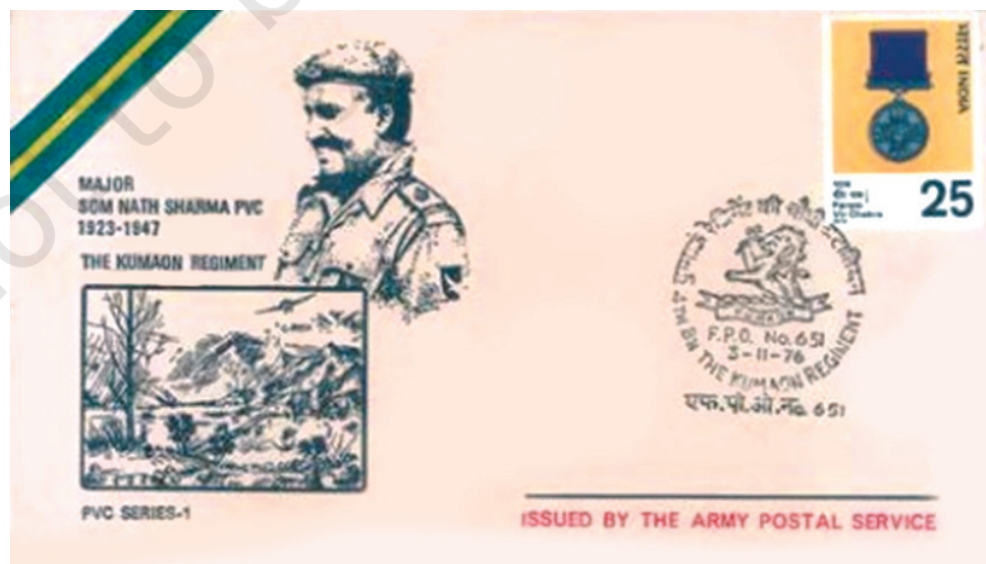
forged: shaped or strengthened, often through hardship

We have delved into how the events of 03 November 1947, played out. It is also worth knowing more about the early life of Major Somnath and the events that led him to make the ultimate sacrifice for the nation.

Born on 31 January 1923, in the picturesque town of Dadh in Kangra, Himachal Pradesh, Somnath Sharma belonged to a family with a rich military **legacy**. His father, Major General Amar Nath Sharma, had served the nation with distinction. Young Somnath was also deeply inspired by the valorous tales of the *Mahabharata*, imparted to him by his grandfather.

From his early education at Sherwood College, Nainital, to his rigorous training at the Royal Military College, Sandhurst, Major Somnath Sharma's life was a **testament** to discipline and dedication. Commissioned into the 8th Battalion, 19th Hyderabad Regiment in 1942, he served with distinction during World War II in the Arakan Campaign in Burma, earning mentions in **despatches** for his bravery. However, it was during the Indo-Pakistan War of 1947–1948, particularly in the battle of Badgam, that the legacy of Major Somnath Sharma was truly **forged**.

The life and sacrifice of Major Somnath Sharma embody the highest ideals of duty, honour, and patriotism. He has been a source of inspiration for soldiers and citizens alike. Most importantly, his story is a reminder of the sacrifices made by countless men and women in defence of the motherland and highlights the profound sense of duty that inspired them.





रक्षा मंत्रालय
MINISTRY OF
DEFENCE

CITATION

CITATION IN RESPECT OF IC-521 MAJOR SOMNATH SHARMA

On 03 Nov 1947, Major Somnath Sharma's company was ordered on a fighting patrol to Badgam in the Kashmir Valley. He reached his objective at first light on 03 Nov and took up a position south of Badgam at 1100 hours. The enemy, estimated at 500, attacked his company position with three sides, the company began to sustain heavy casualties.

Fully realizing the gravity of the situation and the direct threat that would result to both the aerodrome and Srinagar if the enemy attack was not held until reinforcements could be rushed to close the gap leading to Srinagar via Humhama, Major Sharma urged his company to fight the enemy tenaciously. With extreme bravery, he kept rushing across the open ground to his sections exposing himself to heavy and accurate fire to urge them to hold on. Keeping his nerve, he skillfully directed the fire of his section into the ever-advancing enemy. He repeatedly exposed himself to the full fury of enemy fire and laid out cloth strips to guide our aircraft onto their target in full view of the enemy.

Realising that casualties had affected the effectiveness of his light automatics, this officer, whose left hand was in plaster, personally commenced filling magazines and issuing them to light machine gunners. A mortar shell landing right in the middle of the ammunition resulted in an explosion that killed him.

Major Sharma's company held onto its position and the remnants withdrew only when almost completely surrounded. His inspiring example resulted in the enemy being delayed for six hours. Thus, gaining time for our reinforcements to get into position at Humhama to stem the tide of the enemy advance. His leadership, gallantry and tenacious defence were such that his men were inspired to fight the enemy by seven to one for six hours, one hour which was after this gallant officer had been killed.

He has set an example of courage and qualities seldom equaled in the history of the Indian Army.



poignant:
emotional and
sad

In the quiet of the Kashmir Valley, where the echoes of D Company's battle with infiltrators have long since faded, the story of Major Somnath Sharma remains a beacon of courage and sacrifice. His valour ensured that the tricolour would continue to fly over Srinagar, and his name is forever etched in the golden pages of India's military history. The life and legacy of Major Somnath Sharma stands as a **poignant** reminder of the price of freedom and the enduring spirit of those who fought to protect it. His story, marked by selflessness and bravery, will continue to inspire and guide generations to come, ensuring that his sacrifice is never to be forgotten. His name is etched on the Honour Wall of the **National War Memorial**.



Honour Wall with Names of Bravehearts at the National War Memorial



Medal of Honour

Let us salute this braveheart.

*Vande Mataram, vande mataram
Sujalam suphalam malayaja shitalam,
Shasya shyamalam mataram!
Vande Mataram, vande mataram
vande mataram...*

Jai Hind



Let us discuss

I Arrange the following events in chronological order. The first and the last events have been marked for you. Share your answers with your classmates and teacher.

1. Major Somnath Sharma was born in 1923 in Kangra, Himachal Pradesh. (1)
2. Even after losing Major Somnath Sharma, the soldiers fought bravely to save Srinagar for India.
3. The D Company, under the command of Major Somnath Sharma, was flown into Srinagar.
4. Major Somnath Sharma underwent training at the Royal Military College, Sandhurst.
5. Major Somnath Sharma requested air strikes to combat the enemy at Badgam.
6. Major Somnath Sharma was commissioned into the 19th Hyderabad Regiment in 1942.
7. Major Somnath Sharma was killed immediately after a mortar shell hit him.
8. Major Somnath Sharma was the first recipient of the Param Vir Chakra. (8)



Let us think and reflect

I Read the given extracts and answer the questions that follow.

1. *Vastly outnumbered and facing devastating fire, Major Somnath Sharma and his men stood resolute. The air was thick with the sound of gunfire and the cries of battle, but Major Somnath Sharma's voice cut through the chaos, urging his men to fight with tenacity and valour.*





Despite heavy casualties and his own injuries, Major Somnath Sharma displayed unparalleled bravery. He moved fearlessly through the battlefield, directing fire, filling magazines for his gunners, and encouraging his men to hold their ground.

- (i) What can be inferred about the conditions from the line: 'The air was thick with gunfire...'

A. The gunshots had stopped for a while.
 B. There was intense fighting on the battlefield.
 C. The invaders were retreating from the fight.
 D. The Indian soldiers had achieved victory.

- (ii) Complete the sentence with a suitable reason.

Despite heavy casualties, Major Somnath Sharma continued to lead his men because _____.

- (iii) Select the correct option for both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) given below:

(A): Major Somnath Sharma moved fearlessly through the battlefield, even though he was injured.

(R): He believed his courage was important to motivate the soldiers.

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
 B. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
 C. (A) is true, but (R) is false.
 D. (A) is false, but (R) is true.

- (iv) Fill in the blank with the correct word from those given in the brackets:

Major Somnath Sharma was filling magazines, and encouraging his men to hold their ground despite _____.
 (injuries/worry)

2. *Born on 31 January 1923, in the picturesque town of Dadh in Kangra, Himachal Pradesh, Somnath Sharma belonged to a family with a rich military legacy. His father, Major General Amar Nath Sharma, had served the nation with distinction, and young Somnath was deeply inspired by the valorous tales of the Mahabharata, imparted to him by his grandfather.*

- (i) What can be inferred about Somnath Sharma's early influences on his career?
- He was primarily influenced by his father's achievements in the military.
 - His inspiration came solely from the tales of the *Mahabharata*.
 - His family and heritage inspired his bravery and sense of duty.
 - He decided to join the military out of necessity rather than passion.
- (ii) Identify whether the following statement is true or false:
Somnath Sharma belonged to a wealthy family.
- (iii) What does the phrase 'served the nation with distinction' tell us about Major General Amar Nath Sharma?
(He performed his duties with exceptional dedication, honour, and excellence./He was highly respected for his contributions to the country.)
- (iv) Replace the underlined phrase with a word from the extract that has a similar meaning.
My family and I visited a popular hill station and stayed in an old but visually charming house surrounded by trees.

II Answer the following questions.

- 'Major Somnath's legacy of courage and devotion to the nation remains forever alive, forever alive...' What is the significance of the repetition in this line?
- Why do you think Major Somnath's leadership was critical during the Battle of Badgam?
- What were Major Somnath's last words? What do they reflect about his sense of duty?
- What might have been the outcome of the Battle of Badgam if Major Somnath and his company had not held their ground?
- Why do you think Major Somnath's story continues to inspire soldiers and civilians today?
- How can the values demonstrated by Major Somnath Sharma—courage, duty, and self-sacrifice—be applied in our daily lives?



Let us learn

I Match the expressions from the text in Column 1 with the most suitable situations given in Column 2.

Column 1	Column 2
1. Fight to the last man	(i) A sports team scores a last-minute goal, giving them the lead and shaking the opponent's confidence.
2. Foil the plan	(ii) The soldiers fought valiantly until each one laid down his life for the nation.
3. Deliver a blow	(iii) Soldiers stay in their position and fight back, even though the enemy is stronger.
4. Hold their ground	(iv) A spy disrupts the enemy's efforts to invade a country by intercepting their communications.

Now, complete the following sentences using the expressions from Column 1.

- A. The detective managed to _____ by finding the hidden evidence before the culprit could get rid of it.
- B. The company's new advertising campaign was meant to _____ to their competitors' sales.
- C. The hikers chose to _____ despite the heavy rain, refusing to turn back on their journey.
- D. Despite being heavily outnumbered, the soldiers vowed to defend their homeland and _____, refusing to surrender to the enemy forces.

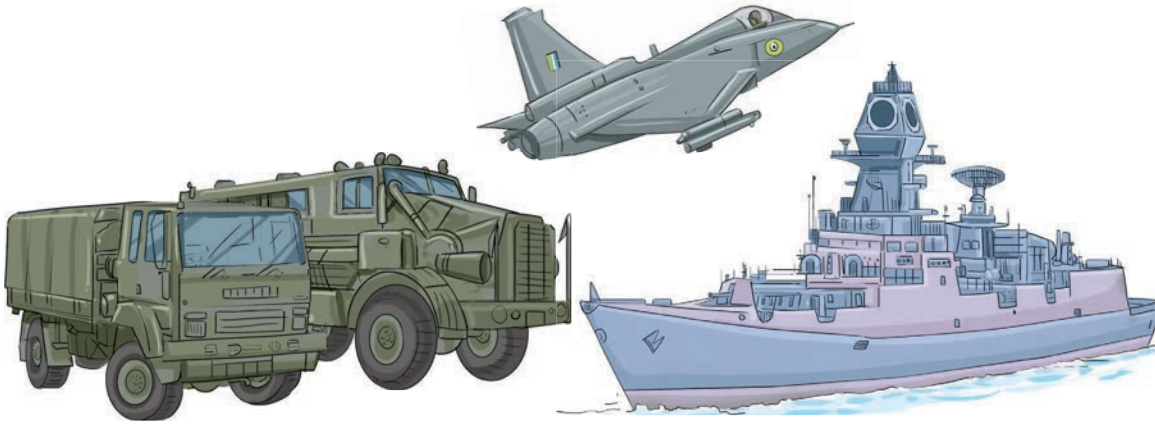
II Read the highlighted words in the following sentence from the text.

A **contingent** of troops posted to Jammu and Kashmir was air-lifted into Srinagar...

There are many such collective nouns used in the context of armed forces.

Match the collective nouns in Column 1 to their meanings in Column 2.

You may refer to a dictionary.



Column 1	Column 2
1. regiment	(i) a large body of troops ready for battle, especially an infantry unit
2. squadron	(ii) a permanent unit of an army typically commanded by a lieutenant colonel/colonel and divided into several companies
3. fleet	(iii) a small unit, typically comprising 12–24 aircrafts and their crews used in air force, naval, or army aviation services.
4. battalion	(iv) a group of ships sailing together, engaged in the same activity, or under the same ownership

Now, fill in the blanks suitably with words from Column 1 in the table.

- A. The commanding officer addressed the entire _____ of soldiers during the morning assembly.
- B. The admiral ordered the entire _____ to set sail for battle.
- C. The _____ of infantry advanced slowly through the dense forest.
- D. A _____ of fighter jets was sent to intercept the enemy planes.



III Read the following words from the text and fill in the blanks with the correct words by taking clues from the meanings given below in the box.

overwhelm overthrow overrun

Meanings

1. To take and seize control: _____
2. To invade or occupy an area in large numbers: _____
3. To flood or overpower someone or something emotionally: _____

Now, create a list of **at least five other verbs** that begin with 'over' and frame sentences of your own.

IV In the following pairs of words, 'c' is used for nouns, while 's' is used for verbs.

- advice (noun) and advise (verb)
- practice (noun) and practise (verb)
- device (noun) and devise (verb)
- council (noun) and counsel (verb)

Now, fill in the blanks correctly with the words given in the brackets.

1. The teacher's (i) _____ is always helpful, and she continues to (ii) _____ students on their career choices. (advice/advise)
2. The musician believes that daily (i) _____ helps a lot, so she is always ready to (ii) _____ her harmonium lessons. (practice/practise)
3. The scientist uses a strange (i) _____ for experiments and plans to (ii) _____ new methods for his analysis. (device/devise)
4. The village (i) _____ met to discuss issues and decided to (ii) _____ the villagers on important matters. (council/counsel)

Read the highlighted word in the following sentence from the text.

*Most importantly, his story is a reminder of the sacrifices made by countless men and women in **defence** of the motherland.*

In terms of meaning, there is no difference between the two words (defence, defense). In American English the word is spelt with an 's', whereas in British English it is spelt with a 'c', which is the preferred spelling. The word has several different meanings, but it is mostly used to mean 'the act of protecting someone or something against attack or criticism'.

V Read the highlighted words in the following sentences from the text.

- ...ended with echoes of courage that **serve** as an inspiration...
- A contingent of troops posted to Jammu and Kashmir **was** airlifted into Srinagar...
- D Company with 90 soldiers **was** the last and they **were** expected to return by 2:00 p.m.
- The life and sacrifice of Major Somnath Sharma **embody** the highest ideals of duty, honour, and patriotism.

The highlighted words are either singular verbs or plural verbs. They are in agreement with the subject of the sentence. This is called **Subject-Verb Agreement**.

Now, fill in the blanks for the following sentences by choosing the correct verb given within brackets.

1. The bouquet of flowers _____ (is/are) beautiful.
2. Neither the teacher nor the students _____ (was/were) aware of the change in the schedule.
3. Each of the participants _____ (has/have) submitted their projects on time.
4. The data collected by the researchers _____ (shows/show) significant trends.
5. One of the players _____ (was/were) injured during the match.
6. Either the children or their guardian _____ (has/have) to attend the meeting.
7. A pair of shoes _____ (is/are) missing from the rack.
8. Neither of the statements _____ (is/are) true.
9. The members of the jury _____ (has deliver/have delivered) their verdict to the court.
10. Mathematics _____ (is/are) an interesting subject for many students.

VI Read the following passage and correct the incorrect usage of verbs. One example has been done for you.

A battalion of soldiers stand at attention as the National flag are raised.

A battalion of soldiers **stands** at attention as the National flag **is** raised.



Each soldier salute with pride while the commander and his assistants inspect the parade. The sound of marching feet echo through the air as a group of cadets prepare for their drill. Meanwhile, a convoy of military vehicles pass by, drawing cheers from the gathered crowd.



Let us listen

I You will listen to a talk about the Param Vir Chakra. As you listen, complete the sentences by filling in the blanks with one or two exact words or phrases you hear. (Transcript for teacher on page 98)

1. The Param Vir Chakra signifies the 'Wheel of the Ultimate _____'.
2. The Param Vir Chakra is awarded to someone who shows exemplary bravery while fighting with the _____.
3. The Param Vir Chakra was introduced as a Gallantry Medal in 1947 by the _____.
4. The design of the Param Vir Chakra is inspired by Sage Dadhichi, who was a _____.
5. The state emblem in the centre of the Param Vir Chakra is surrounded by the *Vajra* and _____.



Let us speak

I As the citizens of a nation, we all must fulfil our duty. In groups of 4-5, speak about how you propose to serve your nation.

You can choose from the themes given below:

- Saving the environment
- Health and well-being
- Helping others
- Righteous conduct

You may use the sentence prompts given below to organise what you speak about.

- I believe one of the best ways to serve the nation is by...
- A small change we can make is... and it will have a big impact because...
- If everyone contributes by... it can lead to...
- One of the biggest challenges we face is... and I propose we address it by...

- We can make a difference by working together as a team, if we...
- Serving the nation is not just about big actions; even small efforts like... matter.



Let us write

I A letter of enquiry is a formal letter written to seek detailed information about something the writer wants to know. For example, it can be used for joining a course, organising an event, knowing details about a trip, etc. The language used is formal and specific, with relevant queries.

Now, write a letter of enquiry. Your school wishes to organise a visit to a Memorial in your state/region. Write the letter to the incharge of that memorial requesting for information regarding available dates for visits, the duration of the tour, any entry fees, and guidelines for student groups.

- Follow the given layout.
- Use the cues given below to draft the letter.

(Sender's address)

(Date)

(Receiver's address)

Subject: Enquiry about a School Visit to a Memorial

Dear Sir,

(Body of the letter)

Yours sincerely,

(Name)



Body of the Letter	Prompts for Enquiry
Paragraph 1: State the purpose of writing	✓ This is to enquire about... ✓ Could you please provide details about... ?
Paragraph 2: Ask for more details	✓ Firstly, I request you to share... ✓ Secondly, I would appreciate it if you could explain... ✓ I would also be grateful to get further details on... ✓ Lastly, could you clarify if... ?
Paragraph 3: Request an early response	✓ An early reply will be greatly appreciated, as it will help... ✓ I look forward to your guidance and support for making this trip meaningful.



Let us explore

- I Out of twenty-one PVC awardees, Major Somnath Sharma was the first recipient of the PVC, and Captain Vikram Batra was the last recipient of the PVC, the highest gallantry award.



A bust of Param Vir Chakra Awardee Captain Vikram Batra at the National War Memorial in Delhi.
(Source: National War Memorial)

Captain Vikram Batra, is popularly remembered as the “Shershah of Kargil”. His iconic success signal was ‘Yeh Dil Mange More’. Captain Vikram Batra, the D Company commander was tasked to capture Point 5140 on 20 June 1999, which he did with exemplary courage. After Point 5140 was captured, 13 JAK RIF was tasked to capture Point 4875. On 07 July 1999, Captain Batra led the assault from the front and engaged in a physical fight with the enemy. He killed five enemy

soldiers at point blank range and himself sustained serious injuries. Despite his injuries, his dauntless determination inspired his men to clear the enemy from a dominating position. Later, he succumbed to his injuries. His fearless determination and leadership encouraged his company men to avenge his death and finally captured Point 4875.

His inspiring leadership, dedication to duty, and steadfast love for his country continue to be an inspiration for the younger generation. He attended the call of duty with absolute disregard for his personal safety. He was awarded the Param Vir Chakra, (Posthumously).

II Gallantry awards in India are given to military personnel and others for displaying extraordinary courage in the line of duty.

Some of the gallantry awards in India are:

- **Param Vir Chakra:** The highest military award in India, awarded for the most conspicuous bravery in the presence of the enemy.
- **Maha Vir Chakra:** The second-highest military award in India, awarded for acts of gallantry in the presence of the enemy.
- **Vir Chakra:** Awarded for acts of gallantry in the presence of the enemy.

Find out more about gallantry awards.

III The Indian government has been steadfast in its initiatives to boost the representation of women in the Indian Armed Forces. These women have been serving the nation selflessly and with pride. Find out the key roles of women in the Indian Army. Share the information with your classmates and teacher.

IV Birsa Munda: A Saga of Courage and Sacrifice

Birsa Munda, a revered tribal freedom fighter, spiritual leader, and folk hero, belonged to the Munda tribe. Celebrated as a valiant warrior and a charismatic figure, he emerged as a powerful symbol of tribal resistance against British colonial rule. Among the people of Jharkhand, he is affectionately known as *Dharti Aaba*—Father of the Land—and is honoured as a divine figure for his selfless dedication to his people.



A commemorative stamp designed by Shri Sankha Samanta captures his powerful presence. It features Birsa Munda addressing his followers, with a determined expression that reflects his unwavering vision of tribal unity, empowerment, and self-governance. This stamp serves as a lasting tribute to his pivotal role in India's freedom struggle and his relentless commitment to protecting tribal rights.

Source: <https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2073652>

V Make a list of the patriotic songs in any language, including songs from your region. Share the songs with your classmates and teacher.